

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Rhetorical Synthesis	Medium

Question

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- 1914: British explorer Ernest Shackleton and a small crew embarked on an expedition to Antarctica.
- 1915: Shackleton’s ship *Endurance* became stuck in ice before eventually breaking apart and sinking.
- 1916: After more harrowing sea-ice adventures, the entire crew was rescued.
- 1959: Historian Alfred Lansing wrote a book called *Endurance: Shackleton’s Incredible Voyage*.
- 2001: Filmmaker George Butler released a documentary called *The Endurance: Shackleton’s Legendary Antarctic Expedition*.
- 2022: The wreckage of *Endurance* was discovered at the bottom of Antarctica’s Weddell Sea.

The student wants to provide a historical overview of the Shackleton expedition. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

Answer

- A. Leaving in 1914 for Antarctica, Shackleton and his crew underwent many harrowing sea-ice adventures, including losing their ship in 1915, before being rescued in 1916.
- B. In 1914, the Shackleton expedition sailed to Antarctica, where, in 1916, they rescued the crew of a ship that had sunk, *Endurance* (the wreckage of which was discovered in 2022).
- C. Shackleton’s expedition has inspired a 1959 book, a 2001 film, and a 2022 discovery.
- D. Alfred Lansing wrote about the history of Shackleton’s 1914–16 expedition in the book *Endurance: Shackleton’s Incredible Voyage* (1959); years later, in 2001, George Butler released a documentary about the expedition.

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence provides a historical overview of the Shackleton expedition, noting that the explorers left for Antarctica in 1914, lost their ship in 1915, and were rescued in 1916.

Choice B is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents information from the notes; Shackleton and his crew were themselves rescued in 1916—they weren’t rescuing others. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence provides examples of works and discoveries inspired by the expedition; it doesn’t provide an overview of the expedition itself. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence provides examples of works made about the expedition; it doesn’t provide an overview of the expedition itself.